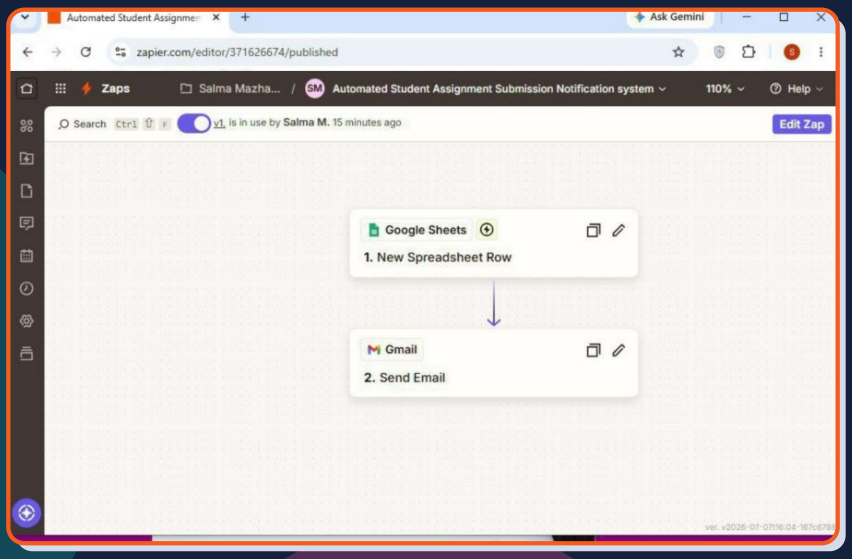
CASE STUDY

Automated Student Assignment Submission Notification System

A no-code workflow that sends every student an instant confirmation email the moment an assignment is submitted.

Zapier | Google Forms | Google Sheets | Gmail | Miro



Salma Mazhar
Workflow automation | Education technology

The Challenge and the Goal

Why this small automation matters

In any classroom or tutoring practice, a student who submits work wants one thing straight away: proof that it arrived. Without it, students ask 'Did you get my file?', teachers answer the same message again and again, and some work is wrongly reported as missing.

Teacher side

Repeated confirmation emails, hard-to-track submissions, and time taken away from feedback and planning.

Student side

Uncertainty after submitting, delayed replies, and no record to point to if a dispute comes up.

The goal

Design a simple, reliable process where every submission is recorded automatically and every student gets a confirmation within moments, using free or low-cost tools that any teacher can maintain without writing code.

How it works

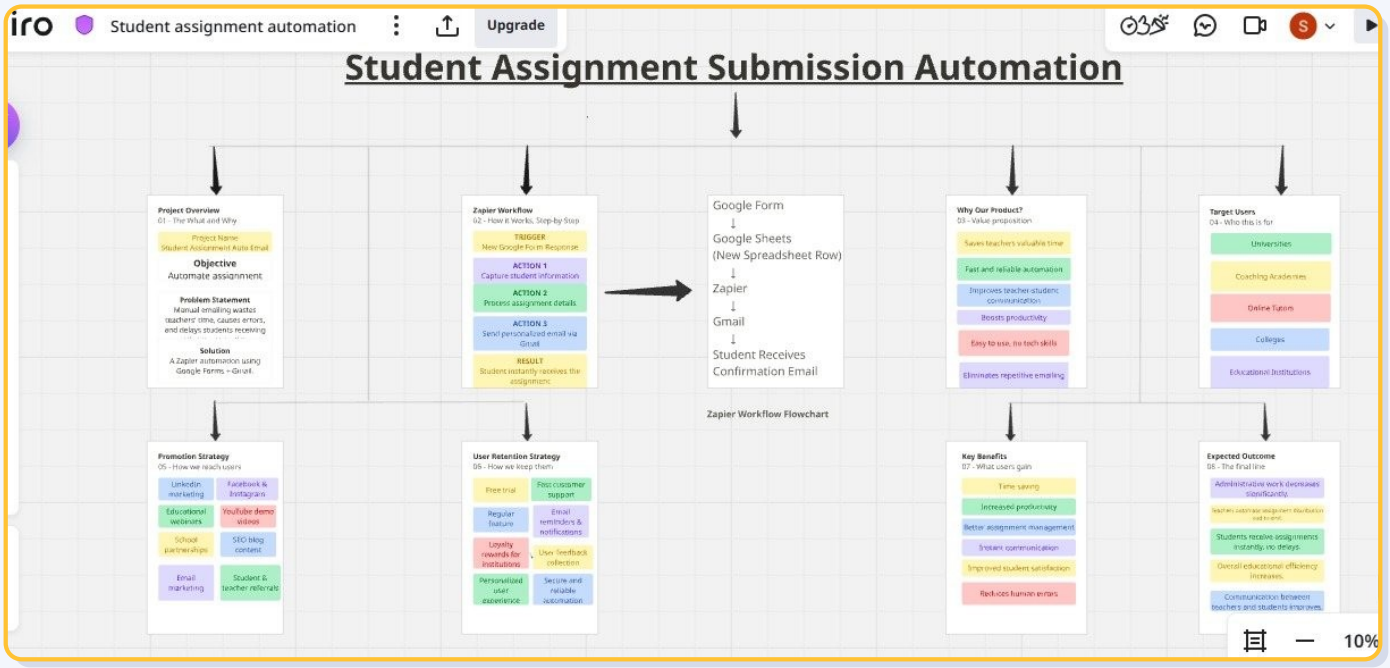


Each response is saved as a row in Google Sheets. Zapier watches that sheet and tells Gmail to email the address the student entered, so the confirmation only goes out after the submission is safely stored.

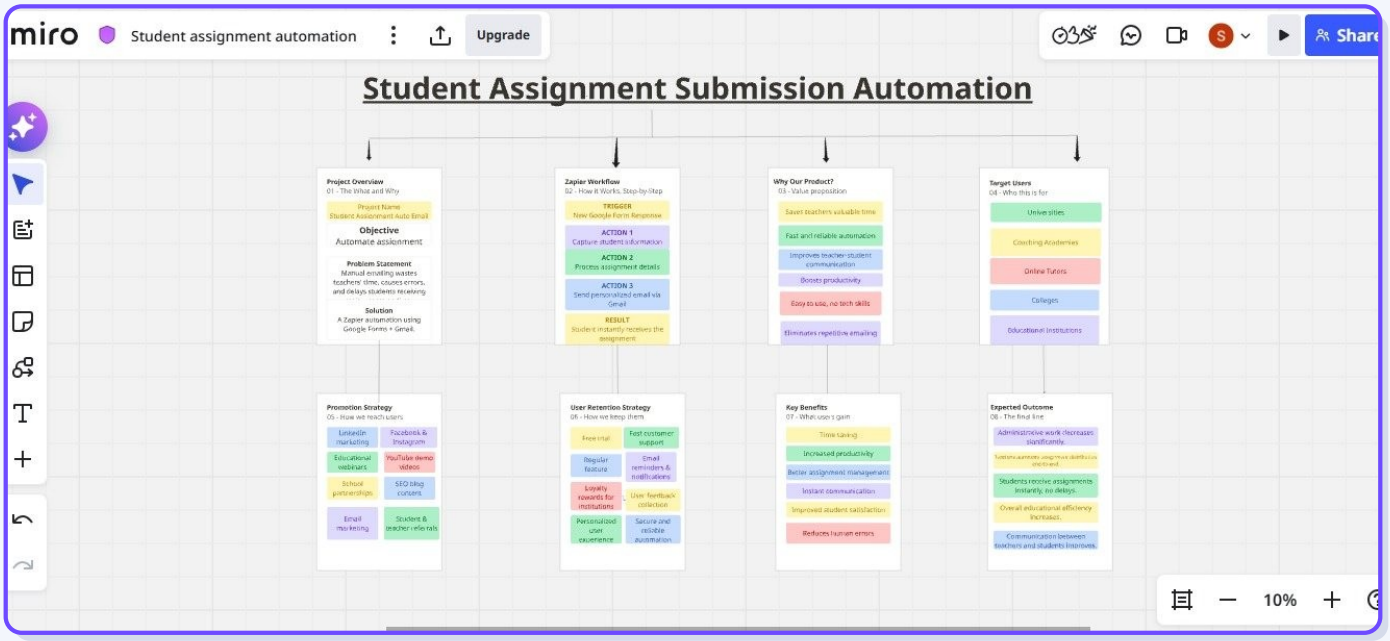
Planning the Idea

Mapped on a Miro board before building

Before opening Zapier, I mapped the project on a Miro board: the problem, the step-by-step workflow, the value for teachers and students, target users, and the expected outcome. Starting with a clear flowchart kept the build small and focused.



Workflow flowchart on the Miro board: Google Form, Google Sheets, Zapier, Gmail, confirmation email.

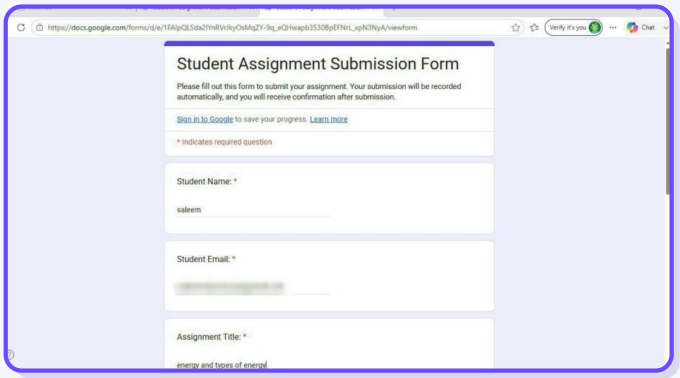


Full board overview: eight planning sections from project overview to expected outcome.

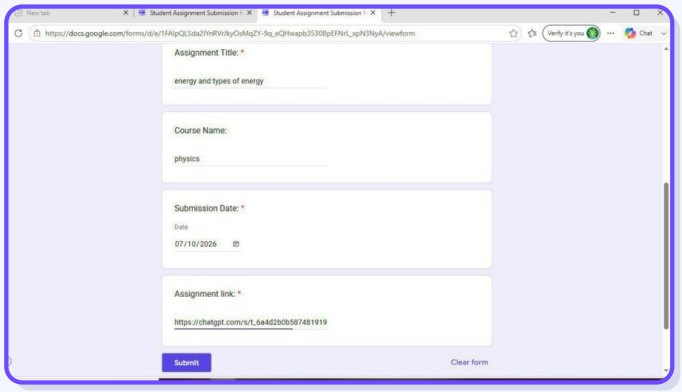
Step 1: Collect Submissions

Google Forms and Google Sheets

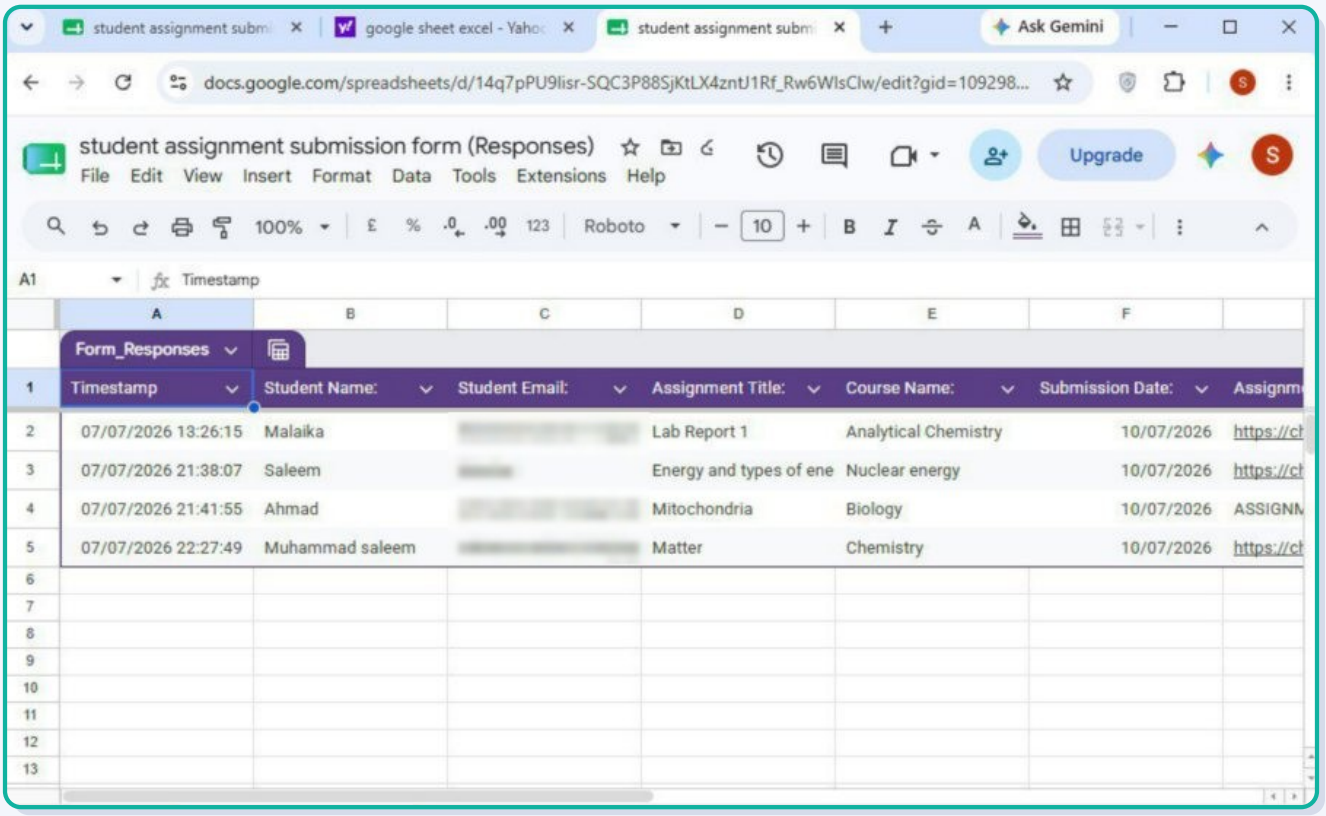
The Student Assignment Submission Form asks for name, email, assignment title, course name, submission date and an assignment link. Required fields keep the data complete, and the form tells students up front that a confirmation will follow.



The form: name, email and title fields.



Course, submission date, link and Submit.

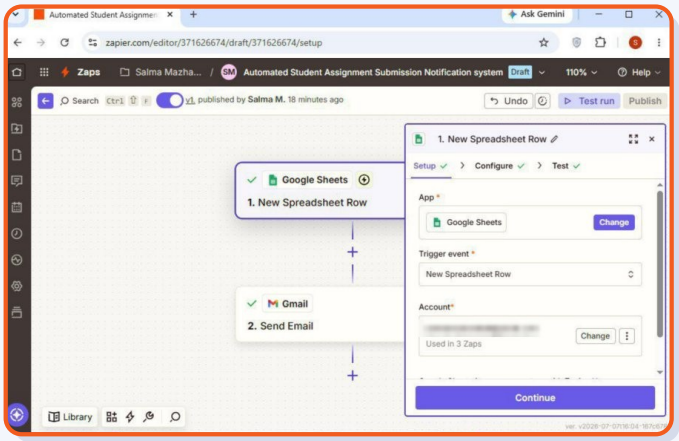


Every response lands in the sheet as a new row with timestamp, student, email, title, course and date.

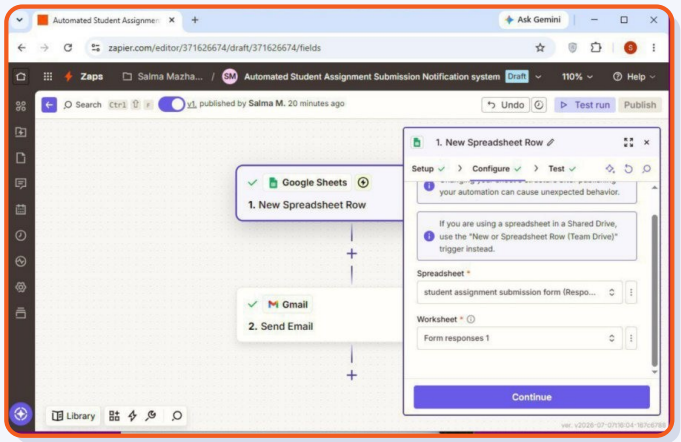
Step 2: Set the Trigger

Teaching Zapier what to watch

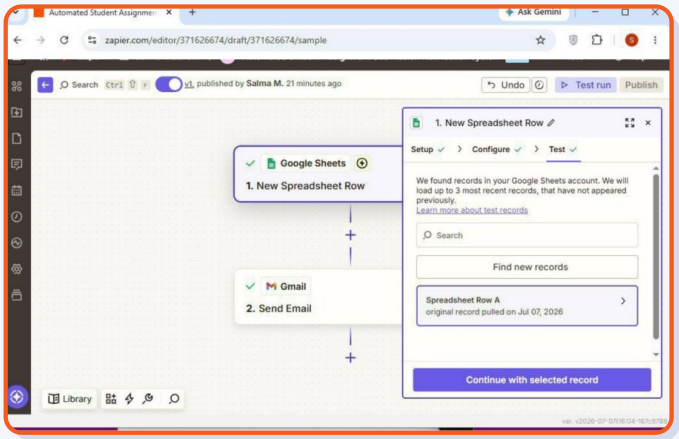
The first step of the Zap uses the 'New Spreadsheet Row' trigger. I connected the Google account, chose the responses spreadsheet and the 'Form responses 1' worksheet, then tested so Zapier could pull a real sample record.



Setup: app, trigger event and account.



Configure: the correct spreadsheet and worksheet.



Test: Zapier found a real record to work with.

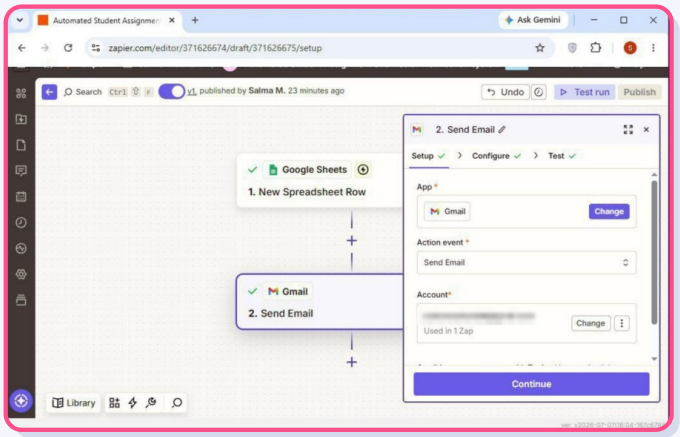
Design decision

Triggering from the sheet, not from the form, means the email only fires after the response has been safely stored. If something fails, the data is never lost.

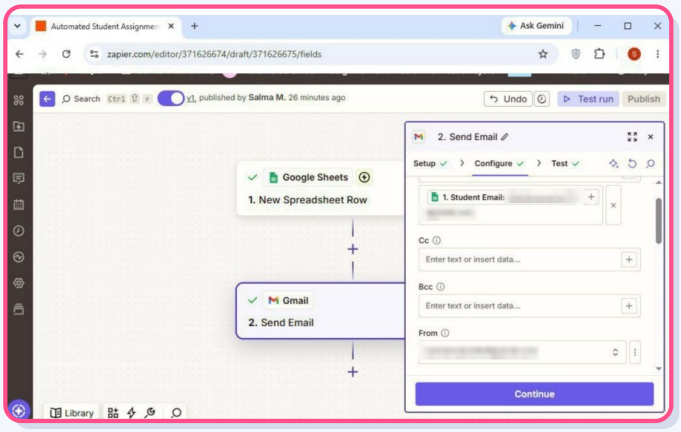
Step 3: Send the Confirmation

Gmail 'Send Email' action

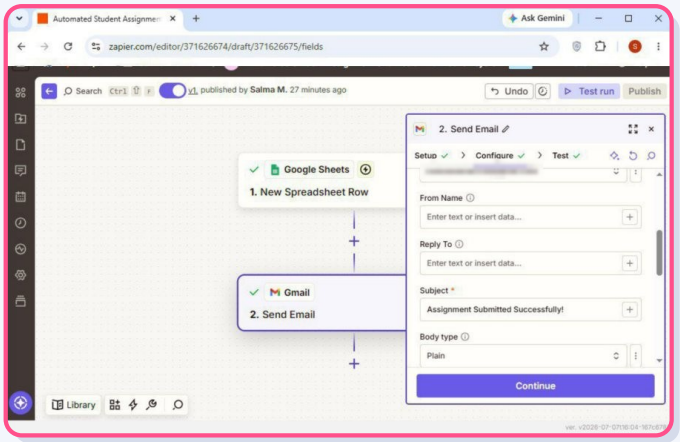
The second step sends the email. The recipient field is mapped to the Student Email column, so every message goes to the person who submitted. The subject, 'Assignment Submitted Successfully!', gives the outcome before the student even opens it.



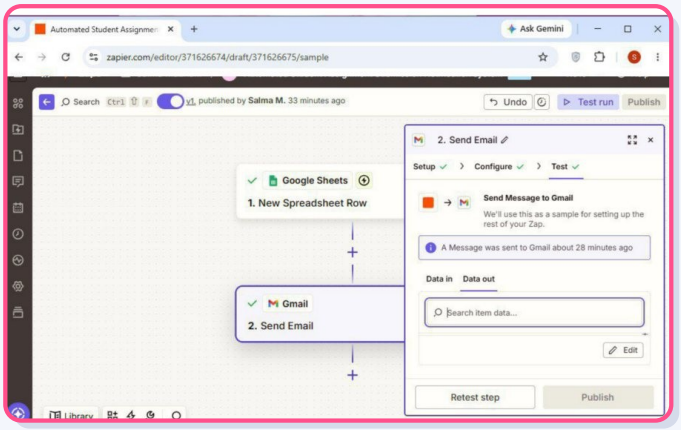
Setup: Gmail and the Send Email event.



Recipient mapped dynamically from the sheet.



A clear, positive subject line.

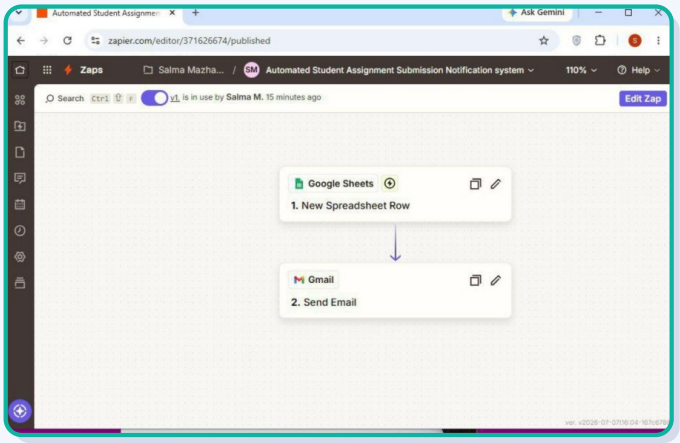


Test: Zapier confirms the message was sent.

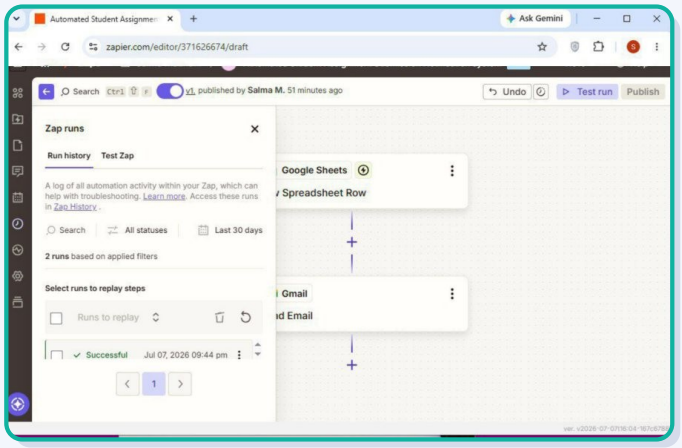
Step 4: Publish and Verify

Testing with real submissions

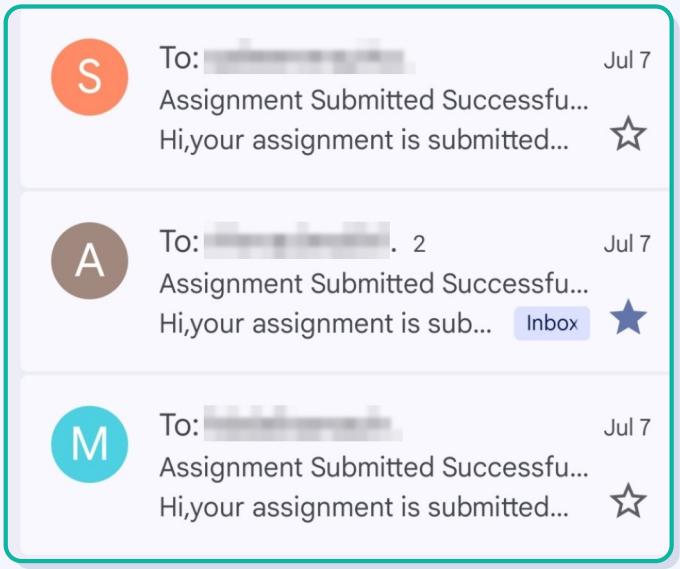
After publishing the Zap, I submitted several test responses and checked three places: the Zap run history, the response sheet and the Gmail sent folder.



The published Zap: Google Sheets to Gmail.



Run history shows a successful run.



Confirmation emails delivered to students.

4 test submissions recorded

3 confirmation emails delivered

1 successful Zap run logged

Lessons and Next Steps

What I learned and how I would grow it

What I learned

Start from the user's worry

The product answers one question: 'Did my work arrive?' Naming that moment early kept the scope small.

Clean data makes reliable automation

The email depends on the Student Email column, so required form fields are part of system reliability.

Test with real records

Sample rows from the actual sheet exposed mapping mistakes a mock-up would have hidden.

Next improvements

Personalise the message

Add student name, assignment title and submission time.

Notify the teacher

Send a daily digest of new submissions.

Handle late work

Compare the date with a deadline and use a different message.

Add a safety net

Alert the teacher if an email fails or an address is invalid.

Need a workflow like this for your classroom or business?

Message me and I will design an automation that saves your time. - Salma Mazhar